

Mario Bennekers Vallejo

Senior Product Manager | B2B & B2C | Scaling Products & Teams



mariobennekers.com

Madrid, Spain
mario.bennekers@gmail.com
[LinkedIn](#)
+34 633 04 04 23

SKILLS

Strategy
Agile development
Product discovery
Data Analysis
Roadmap
AI tools
Leadership
Product Design
Frontend development
Gamification
Renewable Energy
e-Mobility

LANGUAGES

Spanish - Native
English - Advanced
Dutch - Basic

SOFTWARE

Claude Code, Cursor, Notion,
Jira, Google Analytics,
Amplitude, Figma, HTML, CSS,
JS, React, SQL basics, Mixpanel,
APIs, n8n, Elevenlabs.

EDUCATION

Civil Engineering

University of Granada
2007 - 2014. Granada, Spain

Yildiz Teknik Üniversitesi
2011 - 2012. Istanbul, Turkey

Universidad Católica
2014. Valparaíso, Chile

ABOUT ME

Product leader with **7 years** building and launching digital products in **SaaS, energy tech, and gaming**. Hands-on PM who defines strategy and represents the customer, but also writes queries, builds prototypes, and creates **AI agents** to move faster. Engineering background with a P&L mindset — proven track record scaling teams, growing revenue, and delivering in zero-to-one environments.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance

Product Development Consultant
Jan 2024 - Present. Madrid, Spain

- Led Ecometro's first product team (1 year as Interim Product Lead); conducted discovery with 10+ architecture firms and shipped a platform pivot from BC3 to BIM that **grew users from 500 to 1,000** in 4 months, enabling a **funding round** and closing strategic partnerships with their main clients.
- Defined roadmap, pricing, and GTM strategy for Imageryst's satellite imagery platform (6 months), positioning the product for the energy sector and securing partnerships with **Iberdrola, Acciona, and Repsol**.
- Designed product-led growth engine and European GTM strategy for Swish.ai (4 months), an **agentic AI** platform for ITSM serving Intel, Deloitte, and Holcim. Defined freemium tier reducing **time-to-first-value from 3 weeks to <2 hours**, restructured pricing to usage-based tiers, and built DACH market entry plan approved by the board.

CatchIT!

Founder & Product Lead
Sep 2024 - Present. Madrid, Spain

Founded CatchIT!, a two-sided location-based gaming platform connecting digital artists with collectors through geolocation mechanics and limited-edition digital art:

- Shipped cross-platform app (React + Ionic Capacitor) to App Store and Play Store as product builder, using **AI-assisted development** (Cursor, Claude Code) with **zero external funding**.
- Achieved **50% D1, 35% D7, 12% D30 retention** (1.8x to 4.5x above top-25% mobile gaming benchmarks).
- Designed dual-currency monetization system and 70/30 creator revenue share model; built **AI chatbot** (Claude API, RAG, n8n) and automated content moderation.
- Validated core product loop through user research at indie art fairs, competitive analysis, and rapid experimentation — from **concept to live beta in 6 months**.

Maxem Energy Solutions

Senior Product Manager
May 2022 - Jan 2024. Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Led a **10-person cross-functional team** building an API-based EV Charging Station Management System (CSMS), integrating charge point operators and mobility providers via OCPP/OCPI protocols.
- Drove product strategy for Maxem's smart charging algorithm: defined hybrid cloud-local architecture and phased rollout, unlocking enterprise deals with **DHL Netherlands, Watthub, and Schiphol Airport**.
- Created design system in Figma reducing design-to-dev handoff time by **40%**; shipped **12+ features** including onboarding, dashboards, and a full UX revamp.
- Defined tiered pricing strategy based on algorithm complexity, contributing to **2x YoY revenue growth** and **4x increase** in managed charging points in 2023.

EXPERIENCE

RatedPower

Product Manager

Feb 2019 - May 2022. Madrid, Spain

- Joined as **first Product Manager** when company had 5 employees; drove product initiatives central to scaling to 100+ employees and growing ARR from **€230k to €2.5M (10x)** across Europe, LATAM, and Asia.
- Grew engineering team from **2 to 30+**; established product processes from scratch: structured discovery, customer feedback pipeline, roadmap transparency, and agile rituals.
- Shipped core features of the platform like topography, earthwork and financial calculation tools that **won back customers** from main competitor (PVCase), reducing weeks of manual engineering to minutes and opening new market segments.
- Led HubSpot-pvDesign integration automating GTM workflows — saved **~5h/week per rep**, improved data accuracy from **60% to 95%**, and reduced CAC ~5%.

Sabbatical year

Nov 2018 - Dec 2019. South America.

Deliberate career pivot from construction to tech. Self-studied programming while traveling South America, leading to Madrid's startup ecosystem and a product management career.

Solarpack (now Zelestra)

Project Manager

Mar 2015 - Oct 2017. South America & India.

- Progressed from site engineer to project manager across 3 international solar plant deployments (Chile, Uruguay, India) totaling **100 MWp**.
- Delivered **multi-million euro** construction projects **on time**, coordinating cross-functional teams and stakeholders in remote environments (Atacama Desert, rural India).